

DAY 16

Documentation Standards & Version Control

Learning Objectives:

- Understand why documentation discipline is a PM's most underrated skill
- Learn document versioning: naming conventions, version numbers, change logs
- Learn how to maintain a project documentation repository in GitHub
- Understand which documents are living documents vs baseline documents
- YouTube Search Terms:
 - "Project documentation best practices"
 - "Document version control for PMs"
 - "GitHub for project documentation"
 - "Document management in projects"
- Recommended Channels:
 - [ProjectManager.com](https://www.projectmanager.com)
 - Tech With Tim
 - PMC Lounge

Tasks:

- Learn document versioning conventions — understand the difference between a minor version (v1.1 — small correction) and a major version (v2.0 — significant change), and why every document must have a version number, date, and author
- Understand living documents vs baselined documents — a PRD is a living document that changes as requirements evolve, while a signed-off BRD is a baseline that requires a formal Change Request to modify — know which of your documents fall into which category
- Organize your entire GitHub repository properly — create a clear folder structure for all project documents, ensure every document has a version number in its filename, and write a repository README that explains what is in each folder
- Create a Document Register for the Expense Tracker project listing every document by name, type, version, owner, review date, status (Draft/Under Review/Approved), and storage location

Deliverable

- Updated GitHub repository with proper folder structure and README link
- Document Register for the Expense Tracker project
- Short note: what document versioning failure looks like in a real project and how it causes confusion

Why Documentation Discipline Matters

Many projects fail **not because of poor coding**, but because teams work from **different versions of the same document**.

Good documentation helps:

- Everyone works from the latest information.
- Team members can understand the project quickly.
- Stakeholders know what has changed.
- Decisions are traceable.
- Audits become easier.
- Change requests can be tracked.

A Project Manager spends a large amount of time managing documents rather than writing code.

Document Versioning

Document versioning helps the team identify the latest and correct version of a document, preventing multiple people from editing different copies. Every project document should include the **Document Name, Version Number, Date, Author, Status, and Change History**.

Version Number Format

Major-Minor (e.g., v1.0, v1.1, v1.2, v2.0)

- **Major Version (v2.0):** Used for significant changes such as new features, scope changes, rewritten requirements, or major redesigns.
- **Minor Version (v1.1, v1.2):** Used for small updates like grammar corrections, typo fixes, formatting changes, or requirement clarifications.

Example Version Timeline

Version	Description
v1.0	First official draft
v1.1	Fixed spelling mistakes
v1.2	Added requirement clarification
v2.0	Added recurring expenses feature
v2.1	Updated screenshots

Document Naming Convention

A consistent naming convention makes project documents easy to identify, organize, and retrieve.

Recommended Format:

ProjectName_DocumentName_vVersion_Date

Examples:

- ExpenseTracker_PRD_v1.0.docx
- ExpenseTracker_BRD_v2.0_2026-07-10.docx
- ExpenseTracker_RiskRegister_v1.1__2026-06-29.xlsx

Avoid file names such as:

- Final.docx
- Latest.docx
- New Final Final.docx
- PRD Updated.docx

These names do not indicate the document version and often lead to confusion about which file is the latest or officially approved.

Document Change Log

Every document should include a Change Log.

Example:

Version	Date	Author	Changes
v1.0	27-Jun-2026	PM	Initial document
v1.1	29-Jun-2026	PM	Corrected spelling
v1.2	30-Jun-2026	BA	Added login requirement
v2.0	05-Jul-2026	PM	Added recurring expenses module

This helps everyone know exactly what changed.

Living vs Baseline Documents

This is one of the most important concepts in project management.

Living Documents	Baseline Documents
Living documents are updated regularly as the project progresses to reflect new requirements or changes. Examples: • Product Requirement Document (PRD) • Sprint Backlog • Risk Register • RAID Log • Project Schedule • User Stories Example: If a new expense category is requested, the PRD is updated and its version changes from v1.3 to v1.4. Depending on project governance, formal approval may not be required.	Baseline documents are officially approved and serve as the project's reference. Any modification requires a formal Change Request (CR). Examples: • Business Requirement Document (BRD) • Project Scope • Approved Budget • Approved Timeline • Signed Contract Example: After the BRD is approved, if the client requests an AI expense prediction feature, the document cannot be edited directly. The team must: 1. Raise a Change Request. 2. Review the impact. 3. Obtain approval. 4. Update the baseline document.

Comparison

Living Document	Baseline Document
Frequently updated	Fixed after approval
Flexible	Controlled
No formal approval every update	Requires Change Request
Supports daily work	Defines agreed project scope

Updated GitHub Repository Structure

- Created organized folders (Project Charter, BRD, PRD, Risk Register, RAID Log, Change Requests, Meeting Minutes, Status Reports, Test Documents, Final Deliverables).
- Added a [README.md](#) describing each folder and its purpose.
- https://github.com/dhruvg308/pm-intermship-Dhruv_Gupta

Document Register

A Document Register tracks every project document.

S. no.	Document Name	Type	Latest Version	Owner	Review Date	Status	Storage Location
1	Project Charter	Charter	v1.0	Project Manager	27-Jun-2026	Approved	GitHub/01_Project_Charter
2	BRD	Requirement	v1.0	Business Analyst	28-Jun-2026	Approved	GitHub/02_BRD
3	PRD	Requirement	v1.2	Product Owner	30-Jun-2026	Under Review	GitHub/03_PRD
4	Risk Register	Risk	v1.3	Project Manager	Weekly	Draft	GitHub/05_Risk_Register
5	RAID Log	Tracking	v1.1	Project Manager	Weekly	Draft	GitHub/06_RAID_Log
6	Change Request Log	Change	v1.0	Project Manager	As Needed	Draft	GitHub/07_Change_Requests
7	Meeting Minutes	MoM	v1.5	Scrum Master	After Every Meeting	Approved	GitHub/08_Meeting_Minutes
8	Weekly Status Report	Report	v2.0	Project Manager	Weekly	Approved	GitHub/09_Status_Reports

It generally contains: **Project Charter, BRD, PRD, Risk Register, RAID Log, Change Request Log, Meeting Minutes, Weekly Status Report.**

Versioning Failure in Real Projects

Document versioning failure occurs when multiple team members work on different copies of the same document without a clear versioning system. Files with names like "Final", "Final_New", or "Latest" create confusion because no one knows which document is the approved version. This can lead to developers implementing outdated requirements, duplicated work, missed features, project delays, and disagreements with stakeholders. A proper versioning process using clear version numbers, change logs, dates, and authors ensures that everyone works from the correct document and maintains a single source of truth throughout the project.